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Lionnaise carries a golden invitation through the enchanted forest. Beyond the bridge, the feast is waiting. She practises a mighty roar, but it comes out as a squeak.



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A dragon stands across the bridge. Lionnaise stops. He could frighten anyone away, yet his claws twist together and a tiny puff of smoke escapes his nose. He looks worried too.



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Lionnaise holds her crown against her chest and looks up. “Would you like to come to the feast?” she asks. The dragon blinks. “Me? Nobody has asked me before.”



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The dragon smiles and opens the way across. Then he offers Lionnaise a ride above the trees. She holds the invitation tight. “Shall we go in together?” she asks. There is no need for a roar.

Questions for Lionnaise and the Dragon

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1

Talk together: What does the little squeak tell you about how Lionnaise feels?

Page 2

Talk together: Which clues suggest the dragon is worried?

Page 3

Talk together: Why does the invitation surprise the dragon?

Page 4

Talk together: How did a kind question help more than a roar could?

After reading 1

Why did the dragon open the way across the bridge?

After reading 2

What was Lionnaise’s bravest act?

Answers (fold under before reading)

After reading 1: Lionnaise invited him to the feast. Nobody had ever asked the dragon before. Her kind question showed she saw a worried friend, not a monster.

After reading 2: Asking a kind question.